Chainsaw Courses

CHAINSAW MAINTENANCE & CROSS CUTTING · OVERLEAF PUBLISHERS LTD

QMS-003 — Nonconformance and Corrective Action Procedure

Overleaf Publishers Ltd · Co. No. 15735226 · VAT No. 479581629 · Version 1.0 · July 2026 · chainsawcourses.com

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes how Overleaf Publishers Ltd identifies, controls, investigates, and permanently resolves nonconformances — instances where a product, service, or process fails to meet a specified requirement. It applies to nonconformances identified through internal audits, learner feedback, complaints, appeals, incident investigations, management reviews, or day-to-day operation. Document reference: QMS-003.

2. DEFINITION OF NONCONFORMANCE

A nonconformance (NC) is any deviation from a specified requirement. Types include:

TYPE	EXAMPLES
Product / content nonconformance	Inaccurate or outdated course content; quiz question error; broken platform feature
Process nonconformance	Failure to follow Document Control Procedure; supplier engagement without prior approval
Regulatory nonconformance	Failure to meet IIRSM/RoSPA requirement; ICO obligation not met within required timescale
H&S nonconformance	Risk assessment not completed; RIDDOR report not submitted; contractor engaged without competence check
Security nonconformance	Unauthorised data access; failure to apply access control policy; backup failure
Customer / learner complaint	Any substantiated complaint that represents a service failure

3. NONCONFORMANCE RESPONSE PROCESS

STEP	ACTION
1 — Detect and Record	NC identified and recorded in the Nonconformance Register with date, description, category, and identifier of the person raising it.
2 — Contain	Immediate containment action taken to limit the impact (e.g. suspend affected course content pending correction; revoke compromised access credential).
3 — Assess Severity	NC classified as Minor (limited impact, easily corrected), Major (significant impact or systemic failure), or Critical (regulatory breach, safety risk, or data breach).

4 — Investigate — Root Cause	Root cause analysis performed using 5-Whys or Ishikawa fishbone method. Root cause documented in NC Register.
5 — Corrective Action Plan	Corrective actions identified to address root cause (not just symptoms). Actions assigned with owner, target date, and success criterion.
6 — Implement	Corrective actions implemented by the assigned owner within the agreed timescale.
7 — Verify Effectiveness	Effectiveness of corrective action verified by the Director or Lead Auditor. Evidence of effectiveness recorded.
8 — Close	NC closed in the Register with verification date and evidence reference. Closed NCs reviewed for trends at management review.

4. SEVERITY CLASSIFICATION AND RESPONSE TIMESCALES

SEVERITY — CRITERIA	RESPONSE TIMESCALE
Minor — limited impact; no regulatory breach; no safety risk	Corrective action within 30 days
Major — significant impact on learner or business; systemic process failure	Corrective action within 14 days; management review input
Critical — regulatory breach; safety risk; data breach; IIRSM/RoSPA non-compliance	Immediate containment; corrective action within 7 days; escalate to relevant authority as required

5. PREVENTIVE ACTION AND OPPORTUNITY FOR IMPROVEMENT

In addition to corrective action (addressing existing nonconformances), Overleaf Publishers Ltd proactively identifies opportunities to prevent potential nonconformances before they occur, using: trend analysis of the NC Register; results of internal audits; management review outputs; learner feedback patterns; and changes in the regulatory environment. Preventive actions are logged in the Improvement Register and tracked to completion.

6. RECORDS

The Nonconformance Register is a controlled record maintained by the Director. It includes: NC reference, date raised, description, category, severity, root cause, corrective actions, implementation date, verification date, and closure status. The Register is reviewed at each management review and retained for a minimum of 7 years.

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